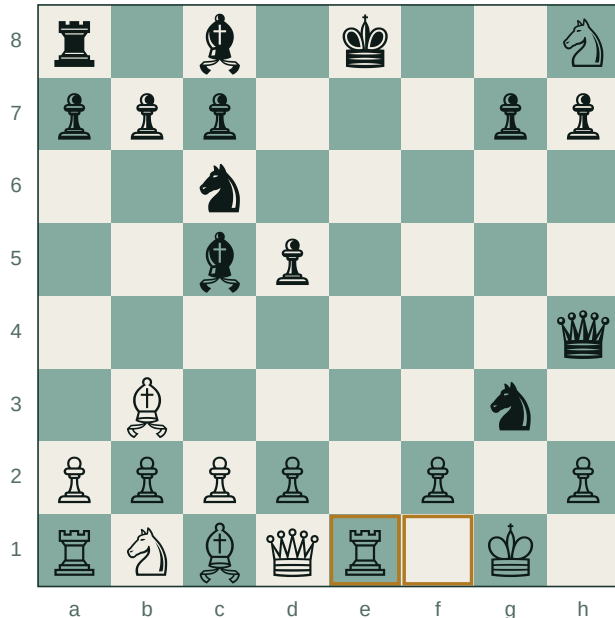


Active defensive resources: Black, move 10

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 10.Re1+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

10...Ne4 11. Rxe4+ dxe4 12. Qh5+ Qxh5 13. Bf7+ Qxf7

10...Ne4 The knight moves from g3 to e4. Recorded reply: **11.Rxe4+**.

11...dxe4 The pawn captures the rook on e4. Recorded reply: **12.Qh5+**.

12...Qxh5 The queen captures the queen on h5. Recorded reply: **13.Bf7+**.

13...Qxf7 The queen captures the bishop on f7.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 29 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +14. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +14:** the balance goes from -5 to +9. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on f2.